

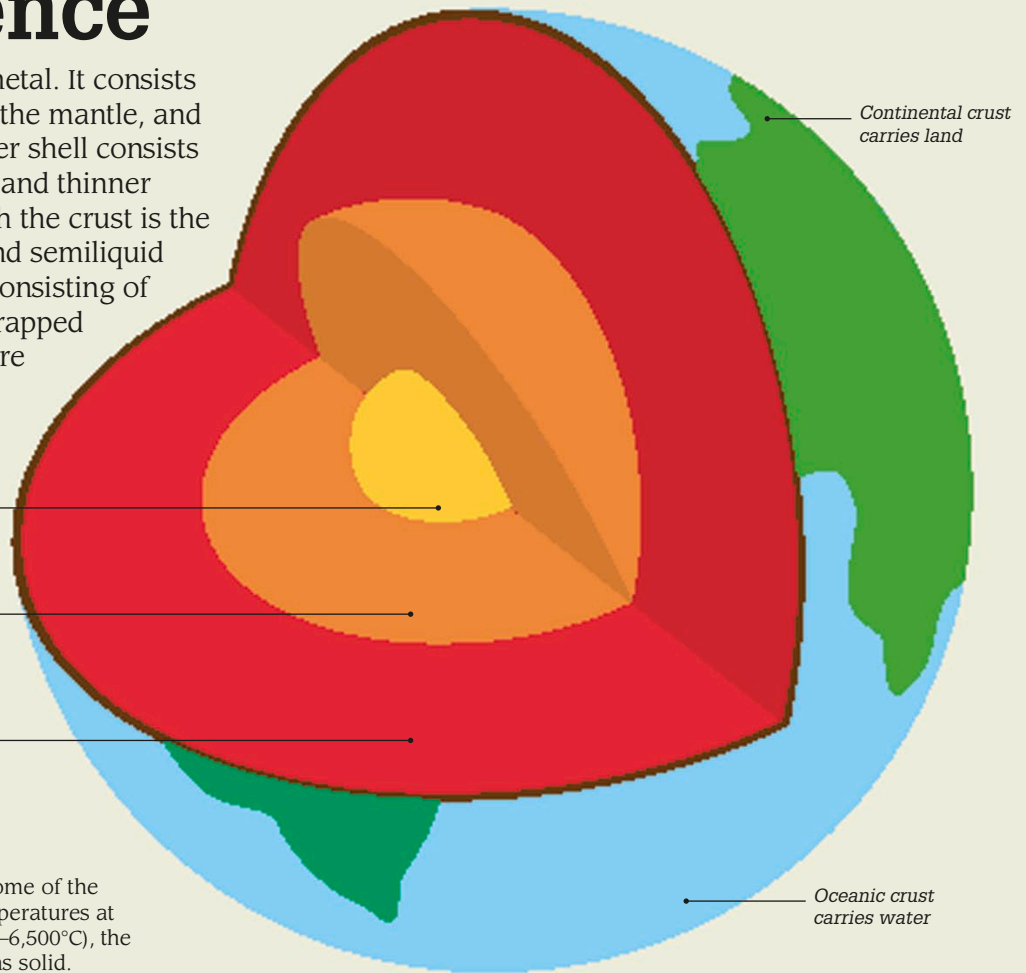
Earth science

Earth is a mixture of rock and metal. It consists of three major parts—the crust, the mantle, and the core. Earth's thin, rocky outer shell consists of thick continental crust (land) and thinner oceanic crust (seafloor). Beneath the crust is the mantle—a thick layer of solid and semiliquid rock. At the center is the core, consisting of an outer layer of liquid metal wrapped around a smaller, solid inner core made of iron and nickel.

The inner core has a radius of about 758 miles (1,220 km).

The outer core is about 1,400 miles (2,250 km) thick.

The mantle is about 1,800 miles (2,900 km) thick.



Inner heat

The intense heat at Earth's core causes some of the rock in the mantle to melt. Although temperatures at the inner core reach 9,000–11,700°F (5,000–6,500°C), the pressure is so great that the metal remains solid.

Earth statistics

Earth is the only place in the Universe known to support life. Over millions of years, various natural processes have combined to create some of the

most spectacular natural features in the world, from high mountains to vast oceans with deep trenches.



Continents

Earth is made up of seven continents—Asia, Africa, North America, South America, Europe, Australia, and Antarctica.



Oceans

The Pacific Ocean is the largest of the world's five oceans, followed by the Atlantic Ocean, Indian Ocean, Southern Ocean, and Arctic Ocean.



Coldest place

The lowest temperature recorded in the world is -128.6°F (-89.2°C) at Vostok Station, Antarctica, on July 21, 1983.



Hottest place

At Death Valley, California, the temperature reached a record high of 134°F (56.7°C) on July 10, 1913.



Living creatures

It is estimated that there are about 8.7 million different species living on Earth—the majority of which are insects.



Highest point

The highest mountain in the world is Mount Everest in the Himalayas at a height of 29,029 ft (8,848 m).



Deepest point

The Mariana Trench in the Pacific Ocean is the world's deepest place with a depth of 36,070 ft (10,994 m).



Wettest place

Mawsynram in India is the wettest place on Earth. It receives an average annual rainfall of 467 in (1,186 cm).